Abdullah Al Zahid

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Avril Bundale
Director, Transit Oriented Communities Policy and Delivery Branch
Ontario Public Service, Toronto, ON

Re: Manager, GO/LRT

Dear Avril Bundale,

I would like to apply for the Manager, GO/LRT position in the Transit Oriented Communities Policy and Delivery Branch. I am an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto, and before that I was a Transportation Planner at Metrolinx, in GO rail service design. The branch works where transit investment meets land use and development, and that is where my work has been.

At the City I review development applications and the transportation studies filed with them against City standards and Official Plan policy, and recommend conditions where something is missing. I advise applicants and staff on transportation planning and related regulations, and with policy staff I recommend and report to Council on new transportation regulations and guidelines. I coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities often conflict, and I write the briefing notes and presentations that carry issues and options to managers in other divisions.

At Metrolinx I ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to test how infrastructure constraints and speed restrictions changed run times and reliability, and worked with schedulers, operations staff and engineers on service design decisions. I also set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. This is a people leadership role, and I have not supervised staff. I have not led transit-oriented community projects, land transactions or government approvals such as Treasury Board submissions, and I have not worked in municipal finance. I am applying because the land use, development and partner side of the role is the work I do every day, from the municipal side of the table, and I would welcome the chance to bring it to the Province's side.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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